

Owl's Night Out

A long time ago, Everything-Maker was busy creating plants, animals and the other things that you now find on Earth.

He gave Owl a body, a loud voice, strong wings and two eyes and then turned to **attend to** Rabbit.

"Give me a long neck like the **swan's**," **hooted** Owl, "and a **beak** like the **hawk's**!"

"Okay, I'll give you everything as soon as I finish with Rabbit," replied Everything-Maker. "And now, I want you to turn around and close your eyes. You know that I don't like anyone watch me work!"

Everything-Maker noticed that Rabbit was **trembling** and so he asked him **gently**, "Do you want something, little one?"

"Yes," said Rabbit **timidly**. "Long legs and ears... a **fang**... and a few **claws**, please!"

"Why do you want a fang?" asked Everything-Maker in surprise.

"Silly Rabbit!" said Owl. "Ask for something useful, like **wisdom**!"

"Be quiet, Owl!" said Everything-Maker **sternly**.

"You have to give us what we ask for," **shouted** Owl turning around to look at Everything-Maker. "And I demand wisdom."



"I've had enough of you!" said Everything-Maker angrily. And he went to Owl and pressed his head down into his body until the neck disappeared. He gave the bird such a shake that his eyes became wide in fright and then he pulled his ears until they stuck out from his head.

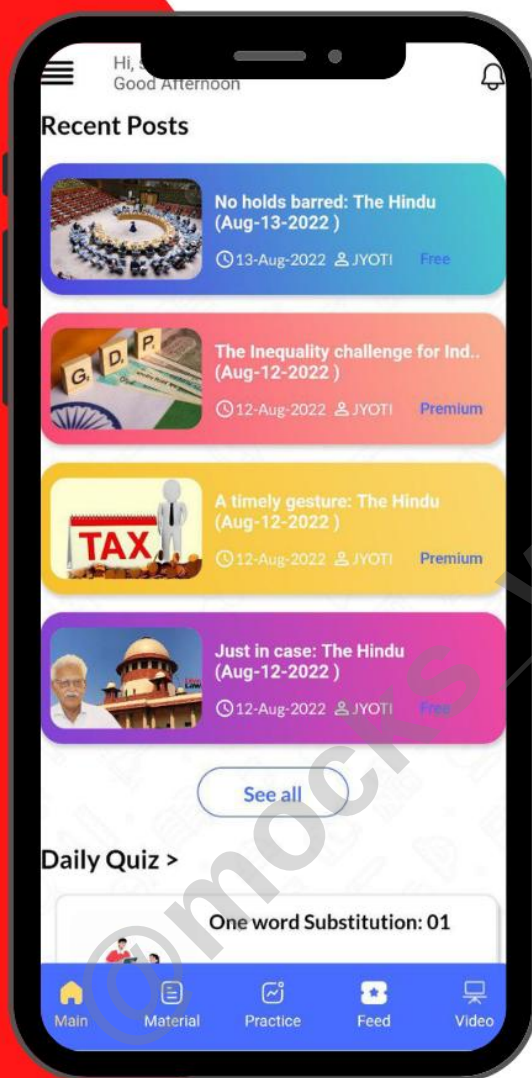
Then **snapping** his fingers, Everything-Maker told Owl, "I have made your ears big, the better to listen. I have made your eyes big, the better to see. I have made your neck short, the better to hold up your head. And, I have packed your head the wisdom, as you have asked. Now you will only come out at night before you see me!"

Everything-Maker then turned to Rabbit and gave him his fangs and claws but the little creature was not to be seen anywhere. **Meanwhile**, owl flew away fast, knowing well that if he made Everything-maker angry again, he would lose all that he had been given.

And since then, Owl has been coming out only at night, after Everything-Maker has gone to sleep.

Vocabulary

1. **Attend** (to) (verb) – care for, look after, deal with, manage, serve पर ध्यान देना
2. **Swan** (noun) – waterbird, wildfowl, aquatic bird, cygnet (young swan), graceful bird हंस
3. **Hoot** (verb) – shout, cry out, screech, call, bellow चिल्लाना
4. **Beak** (noun) – bill, snout, nib, mandible, muzzle चोंच
5. **Hawk** (noun) – bird of prey, falcon, raptor, kestrel, harrier बाज
6. **Trembling** (adjective) – shaking, quivering, shivering, trembling, jittery कांपता हुआ
7. **Gently** (adverb) – softly, mildly, tenderly, calmly, delicately धीरे से
8. **Timidly** (adverb) – shyly, nervously, hesitantly, fearfully, bashfully डरते हुए
9. **Fang** (noun) – canine, tooth, incisor, tusk, biter नुकीला दांत
10. **Claw** (noun) – talon, nail, pincer, hook, fang पंजा
11. **Wisdom** (noun) – insight, knowledge, understanding, intelligence, prudence बुद्धिमत्ता
12. **Sternly** (adverb) – harshly, strictly, firmly, severely, sharply कठोरता से
13. **Shout** (verb) – yell, scream, roar, cry, holler चिल्लाना
14. **Snap** (verb) – crack, pop, click, break, flick चटकाना
15. **Meanwhile** (adverb) – in the meantime, concurrently, simultaneously, at the same time, during this time इस दौरान



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